



*Semele was overwhelmed by seeing Zeus in his godly form.*

“I want you to perform the same display that you did for Hera at your wedding,” Semele requested, “and show me how you look in your godly form.” Zeus was dismayed, because he knew what would happen to Semele if he did what she asked, but, bound by the oath he had made, he agreed.

*The next night, Zeus appeared to Semele riding in an ornate chariot, surrounded by clouds of crashing thunder and flashes of blinding lightning.*

The violent noises startled Semele, and when she gazed upon Zeus approaching in all his shining glory, the sight was so terrifying that instantly she died of fright. Although Zeus was unable to save Semele, he did manage to rescue the baby from her body. The tiny boy was not yet ready to be born, however, so Zeus sewed him into a cut that he made in his thigh. When the infant was ready, Zeus removed him from his leg and named him Dionysus. A new god was born.



*Zeus gave birth to Dionysus from his leg.*